he was succeeded by a very cultured Mahbub Ahmad (a former staff officer to Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose in Burma as an Indian National Army officer) and later by the very thorough and meticulous General T.N. Raina, former chief of the army staff.

As far as my operational work was concerned, I was conscious of the fact that the nature of Shamsher's job and his operational contacts had been fully compromised. Therefore, I preferred to lie low for some time and cut off all links with Shamsher's contacts.

The first Sikh settlers

Before I go on to the period I was posted at Ottawa (September 1976 to September 1979), it would be useful to briefly note the history of Sikh immigration to Canada over the years.

Kesar Singh, a risaldar major in British Indian Army's Sikh Lancers and Infantry Regiment, is considered to be the first Sikh settler in Canada. He was among a group of Sikh officers who were taking the Pacific route, and therefore transiting through Canada on the way back to India after participating in Queen Victoria's diamond jubilee celebration in London in 1897. Sikhs settled in Singapore and Hong Kong and their friends and relatives back home started moving to Canada, first to Vancouver and its suburbs – mainly due to Vancouver's comparatively milder climate and easy accessibility through the Pacific Ocean – and soon from there to the Yuba City, San Francisco and Sacramento areas of the US. Most of them found jobs in farming and lumber (especially in and around Vancouver).

Gradually, they moved on to other professions also. As the British Columbia authorities were busy controlling the Japanese and Chinese influx into their state, the Sikhs arriving in smaller numbers faced no problems in the beginning. As a result, between 1903 and 1908, around 6,000 Sikhs entered Canada, half of them moving southwards to the US. Very soon, they began facing problems with the Canadian civil authorities and Canadian labour of European origin. [1]

The Canadian government decided to curtail this influx with a series of laws aimed at limiting the entry of south Asians into the